decentralization, democracy, and political reform, while acknowledging the seriousness of conflict and rejecting violence.

The ABS findings also indicate that reducing conflict will need to address governance issues. This is a theme long emphasized by scholars (for example, Holliday 2008; Kyaw Yin Hlaing 2012). Reported public perceptions of discrimination, inequality, and a lack of government responsiveness by minorities speak to the need to make improvements in how minorities are engaged. An important ingredient for reduced conflict will be a reduced role for the military in politics.

The ABS findings on conflict also suggest the need to rethink the relationship between political culture and conflict. Scholars of political culture have tended to classify Myanmar's political culture as contributing to conflict. Whether in Maung Maung Gyi's (1983) discussion of personalized power, or the tensions in outlooks between the military's nationalism and values and those of society identified by Robert Taylor (1998, 2015) and Mikael Gravers (1999) among others, or the traditional values supporting limited change and the status quo in society emphasized by Mary and Lucien Pye (1985) and Melford Spiro (1982), the focus has been on accounting for the political culture enabling the military to stay in power for so long.

The ABS findings suggest that Myanmar citizens have rather more conflicting values and political attitudes than scholars tend to assume. On the one hand, Myanmar citizens across communities report to be conflict averse at the individual level, while on the other, there are real differences in how they view government and governance. Myanmar citizens are intolerant and deeply religious, yet at the same time they support inclusive parties and democracy. Myanmar citizens are traditional, tied to the past and conservative values, yet they are calling out for change and reform. These contradictions are not uncommon in survey findings, but they do highlight the need to think more carefully about how values and culture in Myanmar society will shape conflict in the future. There is clearly a need to probe further, using different methodologies besides survey research, to understand how the contradictions play out and why.

Limitations notwithstanding, surveys are an important tool to understand public perceptions and the findings of the ABS debunk some of the standard views of conflict in Myanmar. Of all the factors that stand out in the 2015 survey, the one that is perhaps the most important is that there is indeed support in the public for reducing conflict, including the